FAMILY Herbalist

Healing at Home with Herbs: A Family Herbalist's Guide



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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Rev. Penny Lane Whittemore CNC BCNWP CHGp RHCH is a dedicated and multifaceted professional, recognized as an ICAHP Accredited Holistic Training Provider with a broad array of certifications and achievements. Holding credentials such as a Registered Christian Clinical Herbalist by the Christian Herbalist Guild and a Registered Holistic Christian Herbalist by NHMEC, she brings a wealth of knowledge to her practice. She is also a Board Certified Nutritional Consultant and Natural Wellness Practitioner, with a Doctor of Natural Medicine diploma. Her expertise spans iridology, holistic nutrition, herbalism, and wellness coaching, supported by various diplomas and certificates from esteemed institutions.

In addition to her extensive qualifications, Rev. Whittemore is an ordained minister and a certified faith healer, committed to integrating spiritual and holistic approaches to health. She actively contributes to the community as Vice Chair of the Herbalists Without Borders Board and as a Chapter Volunteer Coordinator. Her creative pursuits include digital artistry and culinary skills as an Herbal Chef. As the founder of several initiatives, including the Junk Journal Ministry and Kids in Action Homeschool, she is passionate about education and community service. Currently, she is expanding her expertise by studying Holistic Addiction Coaching and Trauma-Informed approaches. Her diverse accomplishments and ongoing dedication make her a dynamic and influential figure in the holistic health field.



Family Herbalist

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- MODULE 1A - HEALING AT HOME
- MODULE 3- HERBALIST PATHWAY
- MODULE 9- PENOTHECARY

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Healing at Home with Herbs:
A Family Herbalist's Guide

Module 2

FAMILY HERBALIST

FAMILY HERBALIST



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Chapter 1: The Family Herbalist
What a Family Herbalist Is

Healing at home with herbs is a return to the wisdom of creation—using the plants, foods, and natural remedies provided by God for the health and restoration of the body. This guide introduces the role of a Family Herbalist, the foundations of herbal medicine, and practical ways to create a home apothecary (Penothecary) for everyday wellness and emergency care.

A Family Herbalist is a caretaker of natural health within the home. This person studies the properties of herbs, foods, and natural remedies to support the wellness of family members. The Family Herbalist:

- Understands the body's natural healing processes.
- Uses herbs, nutrition, and prayer to promote balance.
- Keeps a home apothecary stocked with essential remedies.
- Practices discernment and safety when using herbs.
- Works in harmony with biblical principles of stewardship and care.

What a Family Herbalist Does

- Prepares herbal teas, tinctures, salves, and poultices.
- Identifies herbs growing locally and knows their uses.
- Supports the family through seasonal changes and common ailments.
- Maintains records of what works best for each family member.
- Teaches others about natural wellness and preventive care.

What a Family Herbalist Is Not

- Not a medical doctor or a replacement for emergency medical care.
- Not a prescriber of pharmaceuticals.
- Not a practitioner of occult or mystical arts.
- Not a substitute for prayer, faith, or professional diagnosis when needed.

Chapter 1: The Family Herbalist

What a Family Herbalist Is

A Family Herbalist is a caretaker of natural health within the home, guided by faith, wisdom, and a desire to nurture wellness through God's creation. This role is both practical and spiritual, rooted in the understanding that the Creator has provided every herb and plant for the service of humankind. The Family Herbalist studies the properties of herbs, foods, and natural remedies to support the health and vitality of family members, promoting balance in body, mind, and spirit.

The Family Herbalist:

- Understands the body's natural healing processes. The body is designed with an innate ability to heal when given proper nourishment, rest, and care. The Family Herbalist observes these processes and supports them rather than suppressing symptoms.
- Uses herbs, nutrition, and prayer to promote balance. Healing is holistic, involving both physical and spiritual restoration. Herbs and wholesome foods are used alongside prayer and faith to encourage harmony within the body.
- Keeps a home apothecary stocked with essential remedies. Preparedness is a key aspect of stewardship. The Family Herbalist maintains a collection of herbs, oils, and natural preparations ready for use in times of need.
- Practices discernment and safety when using herbs. Knowledge and caution are vital. The Family Herbalist studies dosages, interactions, and proper applications to ensure that each remedy is used safely and effectively.
- Works in harmony with biblical principles of stewardship and care. The Family Herbalist honors the Creator by using His gifts responsibly, caring for the body as the temple of the Holy Spirit, and extending compassion to others through natural healing.

The Family Herbalist serves as a guardian of wellness, blending ancient wisdom with modern understanding. This calling is not about replacing medical care but about restoring the home as a place of healing, learning, and faith-based stewardship. Through prayer, study, and practice, the Family Herbalist becomes a vessel of God's provision, using the leaves for medicine and the fruits for nourishment, as written in Ezekiel 47:12 (KJV):

"...and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine."

What a Family Herbalist Does

The Family Herbalist is both a student and a steward of natural health. Their work involves practical skills, observation, and continual learning.

- Prepares herbal teas, tinctures, salves, and poultices. These preparations form the foundation of home herbal care, addressing everything from digestion to skin healing.
- Identifies herbs growing locally and knows their uses. The Family Herbalist learns to recognize God's pharmacy in the garden, field, and forest, understanding which plants are safe and beneficial.
- Supports the family through seasonal changes and common ailments. From colds and flu to allergies and fatigue, the Family Herbalist provides gentle, natural support to strengthen the body's resilience.
- Maintains records of what works best for each family member. Every person is unique. The Family Herbalist keeps notes on responses to herbs, dosages, and preferences to refine care over time.
- Teaches others about natural wellness and preventive care. Knowledge is meant to be shared. The Family Herbalist encourages others to take responsibility for their health through education and example.

This role is one of service, compassion, and continual growth. The Family Herbalist learns from experience, Scripture, and creation itself, always seeking to glorify God through the care of His people.

What a Family Herbalist Is Not

Understanding what a Family Herbalist is not is as important as knowing what they are. This clarity ensures safety, integrity, and alignment with biblical principles.

- Not a medical doctor or a replacement for emergency medical care. Herbal wisdom complements, but does not replace, professional medical attention when necessary.
- Not a prescriber of pharmaceuticals. The Family Herbalist works with natural remedies, not synthetic drugs or controlled substances.
- Not a practitioner of occult or mystical arts. Herbalism is a study of God's creation, not a practice of divination, magic, or spiritual manipulation.
- Not a substitute for prayer, faith, or professional diagnosis when needed. True healing involves both faith and wisdom. The Family Herbalist encourages prayer, discernment, and seeking appropriate help when required.

The Family Herbalist walks in humility, recognizing that all healing ultimately comes from the Lord. Their purpose is to serve as a faithful steward of the natural gifts He has provided, using them with reverence, knowledge, and love.

Chapter 2: Setting Up a Home Apothecary (Penothecary)

The Purpose of a Penothecary

A Penothecary is a sacred space for preparing and storing herbal remedies. It reflects stewardship, order, and readiness to care for the family's health naturally.

Essentials for a Penothecary

- Storage: Glass jars, amber bottles, and airtight tins.
- Tools: Mortar and pestle, measuring spoons, funnels, strainers, and labels.
- Base Ingredients: Alcohol (for tinctures), olive or coconut oil (for salves), beeswax, honey, vinegar, and distilled water.
- Herbs to Begin With:
  - Chamomile – calming and digestive support
  - Peppermint – cooling and antispasmodic
  - Echinacea – immune support
  - Calendula – skin healing
  - Ginger – warming and anti-nausea
  - Garlic – antimicrobial
  - Plantain – wound healing
  - Lavender – relaxation and antiseptic

Organizing the Penothecary

- Label all jars with herb name, date, and source.
- Store herbs away from light and moisture.
- Keep a notebook of recipes, dosages, and results.

Chapter 2: Setting Up a Home Apothecary (Penothecary)

The Purpose of a Penothecary

A Penothecary is a sacred space within the home dedicated to the preparation and storage of herbal remedies. It is more than a collection of jars and bottles—it is a reflection of stewardship, order, and readiness to care for the family's health naturally. The Penothecary embodies the principle of being prepared in season and out of season, ensuring that the family has access to natural support for wellness and healing.

This space serves as a reminder that God has provided everything needed for health and restoration through His creation. The Family Herbalist tends the Penothecary with reverence, gratitude, and diligence, maintaining it as a place of learning, prayer, and healing.

Essentials for a Penothecary

A well-equipped Penothecary begins with simple, practical tools and ingredients. Each item serves a purpose in the preparation and preservation of herbal remedies.

Storage

- Glass jars: Ideal for storing dried herbs and loose blends.
- Amber bottles: Protect tinctures and oils from light exposure.
- Airtight tins: Preserve teas, powders, and salves.

Tools

- Mortar and pestle: For grinding herbs and seeds.
- Measuring spoons: Ensure accurate proportions in recipes.
- Funnels and strainers: Assist in transferring and filtering liquids.
- Labels: Keep every preparation clearly identified with name, date, and contents.

Base Ingredients

- Alcohol: Used for tinctures and herbal extracts.
- Olive or coconut oil: Serve as carriers for infused oils and salves.
- Beeswax: Solidifies salves and balms.
- Honey: Acts as a natural preservative and sweetener in syrups.
- Vinegar: Useful for herbal vinegars and non-alcoholic extracts.
- Distilled water: Provides purity for teas, washes, and infusions.

Chapter 2: Setting Up a Home Apothecary (Penothecary)

The Purpose of a Penothecary

Herbs to Begin With

Starting with a small, versatile collection of herbs allows the Family Herbalist to create a wide range of remedies for common needs.

- Chamomile: Calming, digestive support, and gentle enough for children.
- Peppermint: Cooling, antispasmodic, and refreshing for digestion and headaches.
- Echinacea: Strengthens the immune system and supports recovery from illness.
- Calendula: Promotes skin healing and soothes inflammation.
- Ginger: Warming, anti-nausea, and supportive for circulation and digestion.
- Garlic: Antimicrobial and immune-boosting, beneficial for infections and colds.
- Plantain: Excellent for wound healing, insect bites, and skin irritations.
- Lavender: Relaxing, antiseptic, and supportive for sleep and stress relief.

These foundational herbs can be used in teas, tinctures, salves, and poultices, forming the core of a functional home apothecary.

Organizing the Penothecary

Order and cleanliness are essential in maintaining the integrity of herbal preparations. A well-organized Penothecary ensures that remedies are safe, effective, and easy to access when needed.

- Label all jars with herb name, date, and source. This prevents confusion and ensures freshness.
- Store herbs away from light and moisture. Keep them in a cool, dark place to preserve potency.
- Keep a notebook of recipes, dosages, and results. Record observations, adjustments, and family responses to each remedy for future reference.

A Penothecary is a living space—constantly growing, changing, and reflecting the rhythm of the seasons. It is a place of stewardship and service, where the Family Herbalist honors the Creator by using His gifts wisely and with gratitude.

Chapter 3: Basics of Herbal Medicine
Understanding Herbal Actions

Chapter 3: Basics of Herbal Medicine

Understanding Herbal Actions

- Adaptogens: Support the body’s stress response (Ashwagandha, Holy Basil).
- Nervines: Calm the nervous system (Lemon Balm, Skullcap).
- Carminatives: Aid digestion (Fennel, Peppermint).
- Expectorants: Clear mucus (Mullein, Thyme).
- Astringents: Tighten tissues (Witch Hazel, Raspberry Leaf).
- Demulcents: Soothe mucous membranes (Marshmallow Root, Slippery Elm).

Forms of Herbal Preparations

- Infusions (Teas): Steep leaves or flowers in hot water.
- Decoctions: Simmer roots or bark for 15–30 minutes.
- Tinctures: Extract herbs in alcohol or glycerin.
- Syrups: Combine herbal decoctions with honey.
- Salves: Infuse herbs in oil and blend with beeswax.
- Poultices: Apply crushed herbs directly to the skin.

Chapter 3: Basics of Herbal Medicine
Understanding Herbal Actions

Herbal medicine is built upon the understanding that each plant carries unique properties and actions that influence the body in specific ways. These actions describe how herbs interact with the body's systems to restore balance, support healing, and maintain wellness. Recognizing these categories helps the Family Herbalist choose the right herb for each need.

Adaptogens
Adaptogens help the body adapt to stress, whether physical, emotional, or environmental. They strengthen the body's resilience and promote balance in the adrenal and nervous systems.
Examples: Ashwagandha, Holy Basil
Nervines
Nervines calm, nourish, and strengthen the nervous system. They are useful for anxiety, tension, and sleep disturbances, helping the body relax naturally.
Examples: Lemon Balm, Skullcap
Carminatives
Carminatives aid digestion by soothing the stomach, reducing gas, and easing cramping. They often have aromatic oils that relax the digestive tract.
Examples: Fennel, Peppermint
Expectorants
Expectorants help clear mucus from the lungs and airways, supporting respiratory health during colds, coughs, and congestion.
Examples: Mullein, Thyme
Astringents
Astringents tighten and tone tissues, reducing excess secretions and inflammation. They are often used for skin care, sore throats, and digestive issues.
Examples: Witch Hazel, Raspberry Leaf
Demulcents
Demulcents soothe and protect mucous membranes by forming a gentle coating. They are beneficial for sore throats, dry coughs, and digestive irritation.
Examples: Marshmallow Root, Slippery Elm
Understanding these herbal actions allows the Family Herbalist to match the right herb to the body's needs, supporting natural healing in a balanced and effective way.

Chapter 3: Basics of Herbal Medicine
Forms of Herbal Preparations

Herbs can be prepared in many forms, each designed to extract and deliver their healing properties in the most effective manner. The method chosen depends on the part of the plant used and the desired outcome.

Infusions (Teas)
Infusions are made by steeping leaves, flowers, or soft plant parts in hot water. This gentle method extracts vitamins, minerals, and aromatic compounds.
Example: Chamomile or Peppermint tea for relaxation and digestion.
Decoctions
Decoctions are used for tougher plant materials such as roots, bark, and seeds. Herbs are simmered in water for 15–30 minutes to draw out deeper constituents.
Example: Ginger or Licorice root decoction for immune and digestive support.
Tinctures
Tinctures are concentrated liquid extracts made by soaking herbs in alcohol or glycerin. They preserve the herb's active compounds and have a long shelf life.
Example: Echinacea tincture for immune support.
Syrups
Syrups combine herbal decoctions with honey or another natural sweetener. They are soothing, pleasant-tasting, and ideal for children or throat remedies.
Example: Elderberry syrup for colds and flu.
Salves
Salves are topical preparations made by infusing herbs in oil and blending with beeswax. They protect and heal the skin, providing moisture and herbal benefits.
Example: Calendula salve for cuts, scrapes, and dry skin.
Poultices
Poultices are made by crushing fresh or dried herbs and applying them directly to the skin. They draw out toxins, reduce inflammation, and promote healing.
Example: Plantain poultice for insect bites or minor wounds.

Herbal medicine is both an art and a science, combining observation, preparation, and prayerful intention. By understanding herbal actions and mastering basic preparations, the Family Herbalist becomes equipped to care for the home with confidence, wisdom, and faith in the Creator's provision.

Chapter 4: Everyday Herbal Recipes for Common Ailments

Cold and Flu
Immune Tea:

- 1 tsp Echinacea root
- 1 tsp Elderberries
- ½ tsp Ginger root
- ½ tsp Peppermint leaf
- Steep in 2 cups hot water for 15 minutes. Drink warm with honey.

Cough
Soothing Cough Syrup:

- 1 cup water
- 1 tbsp Mullein leaf
- 1 tbsp Licorice root
- 1 tbsp Honey
- Simmer herbs for 20 minutes, strain, and add honey. Take 1 tsp as needed.

Headache
Herbal Compress:

- 1 tbsp Lavender flowers
- 1 tbsp Peppermint leaf
- Steep in hot water, soak a cloth, and apply to forehead.

Digestive Upset
Tummy Tea:

- 1 tsp Chamomile
- ½ tsp Fennel seed
- ½ tsp Ginger
- Steep for 10 minutes. Drink after meals.

Stress and Sleep
Calming Tea:

- 1 tsp Lemon Balm
- 1 tsp Chamomile
- ½ tsp Passionflower
- Steep for 10 minutes before bedtime.

Chapter 5: First Aid and Emergency Herbal Care

Cuts and Scrapes
Healing Salve:

- 1 cup Olive oil infused with Calendula and Plantain
- ¼ cup Beeswax
- 10 drops Lavender essential oil
- Melt and blend. Apply to clean wounds.

Burns
Aloe and Lavender Gel:

- 2 tbsp Aloe vera gel
- 5 drops Lavender essential oil
- Apply gently to affected area.

Insect Bites
Anti-Itch Spray:

- ½ cup Witch Hazel
- 10 drops Tea Tree oil
- 10 drops Peppermint oil
- Shake and spray on bites.

Sore Muscles
Herbal Liniment:

- 1 cup Rubbing alcohol
- 1 tbsp Arnica flowers
- 1 tbsp Cayenne pepper
- Infuse for 2 weeks, strain, and apply externally.

Fever
Cooling Tea:

- 1 tsp Yarrow
- 1 tsp Peppermint
- 1 tsp Elderflower
- Steep for 15 minutes. Drink warm to promote sweating.

Chapter 6: Healing Foods and Supplements

Healing Foods

- Garlic and onions for immune support
- Bone broth for minerals and gut healing
- Leafy greens for detoxification
- Berries for antioxidants
- Fermented foods for gut flora balance

Key Supplements

- Vitamin C for immune defense
- Zinc for wound healing
- Magnesium for relaxation and muscle function
- Probiotics for digestive health
- Omega-3 oils for inflammation control

Chapter 7: The Holistic PenWay Approach

The Holistic PenWay emphasizes prayer, discernment, and stewardship in natural healing. It integrates biblical principles with herbal wisdom, encouraging families to seek balance in body, mind, and spirit.

Scripture Meditation:
“...and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine.” — Ezekiel 47:12 (KJV)

Chapter 8: Continuing the Journey

Becoming a Family Herbalist is a lifelong path of learning and service. Keep studying, observing, and recording results. Share knowledge with others and maintain humility before the Creator, the true Healer.

Appendix: Quick Reference Herbal Chart

Ailment	Herbs	Form	Notes
Cold/Flu	Echinacea, Elderberry, Ginger	Tea, Syrup	Boost immunity
Cough	Mullein, Licorice, Thyme	Tea, Syrup	Soothes throat
Headache	Peppermint, Lavender	Compress, Tea	Relieves tension
Digestive Upset	Chamomile, Fennel, Ginger	Tea	Eases bloating
Stress/Anxiety	Lemon Balm, Passionflower	Tea, Tincture	Calms nerves
Cuts/Wounds	Calendula, Plantain	Salve	Promotes healing
Burns	Aloe, Lavender	Gel	Soothes skin
Muscle Pain	Arnica, Cayenne	Liniment	Stimulates circulation

Healing at home with herbs is both an art and a ministry. Through faith, knowledge, and care, every family can cultivate a home of wellness rooted in God’s provision and natural wisdom.







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